

Bangkok Shambhala

Admin Walkthrough Guide

Website Administration Manual

Version 1.0 — March 2026

1. Introduction

Welcome to the Bangkok Shambhala website administration guide. This document walks you through every aspect of managing the site, from creating events to publishing blog posts and monitoring site health.

Who is this guide for?

- Community coordinators who manage events
- Content editors who write blog posts
- Site administrators who oversee the website

What you'll need:

- A modern web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
 - Your admin login credentials (email and password, configured by the site administrator)
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2. Accessing the Admin Area

2.1 Logging In

1. Open your browser
2. Navigate to `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/admin/login`
3. Enter your **email** and **password**
4. If captcha is enabled, complete the Cloudflare Turnstile challenge
5. Click **Sign In**

Note: Your session lasts 24 hours. After that, you'll need to log in again.

2.2 Admin Dashboard

After logging in, you'll see the dashboard at `/admin/` :

- **Stats tiles** — total events, blog posts

- **Quick actions** — links to create new events or posts
- **Upcoming events** — next scheduled events
- **Recent posts** — latest blog articles

2.3 Navigation

The admin sidebar includes:

- **Dashboard** — overview and quick actions
 - **Events** — list all events, create new, edit existing
 - **Posts** — list all blog posts, create new, edit existing
 - **View Site** — open the public website
 - **Logout** — end your session
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3. Managing Events

3.1 Creating a New Event

1. Click **Events** in the admin navigation, then **+ New Event** Or click **+ New Event** from the dashboard
2. Fill in the required fields:

Field	Required	Description
Title	Yes	Event name (e.g., "Wednesday Evening Meditation")
Slug	Auto	URL path — auto-generated from title, editable
Start Date	Yes	Event start with time (timezone auto-appended as +07:00)
End Date	Yes	Event end with time
Summary	Yes	1-2 sentences for event cards and search results
Body	Yes	Full description using the Markdown editor
Modality	Yes	in-person , online , or hybrid
Pricing	Yes	free , donation , or paid
Status	Yes	upcoming , cancelled , or past
Location	Yes	Pre-filled with default venue address

Optional fields:

Field	Description
Tags	Categories: meditation, workshop, retreat, online, etc.
Featured Image	URL for the event banner image
Facilitator	Who leads the session
Capacity	Limit (leave empty for unlimited)
Price Amount	Numeric amount for paid events
Price Currency	THB, USD, EUR

3. Use the **Markdown toolbar** to format the body (Bold, Italic, Headings, Lists, Links, Images)

4. Click **Save Event**

Important: After saving, the site rebuilds automatically. Changes appear within 1-2

minutes.

3.2 Editing an Event

1. Go to **Events** in the admin navigation
2. Find the event and click **Edit**
3. Make your changes
4. Click **Save Event**

3.3 Event Lifecycle

Follow this workflow for every event:

```
CREATE event (status: upcoming)
  ↓
EVENT HAPPENS
  ↓
Edit → change status to "past"
  ↓
(Optional) Add recap or photos to the body
```

Cancelling an event:

1. Open the event for editing
2. Change Status to `cancelled`
3. Add a notice at the top of the body: `> **This event has been cancelled.**`
4. Save

3.4 Recurring Events

For weekly sessions (e.g., Wednesday Meditation):

1. Create one event per session date
2. Use a consistent naming convention: `Wednesday Evening Meditation – March 25`
3. Keep the same slug prefix: `wednesday-evening-meditation-2026-03-25`
4. You can create a new event and reuse similar content from a previous one

Tip: Create events at least 2 weeks in advance so they appear in the weekly digest.

3.5 Event Calendar Feed

The site automatically generates an ICS calendar feed at:

- **All events:** `/api/calendar/feed.ics`
- **Single event:** `/api/events/[slug]/ics`

Users can subscribe to the feed in Google Calendar, Apple Calendar, or Outlook. No action needed from you — this is fully automatic.

4. Managing Blog Posts

4.1 Creating a New Post

1. Click **Posts** in the admin navigation, then **+ New Post**
2. Fill in the fields:

Field	Required	Description
Title	Yes	Article headline
Slug	Auto	URL path (auto-generated from title)
Date	Yes	Publication date
Author	Yes	Author name (defaults to "Bangkok Shambhala")
Excerpt	Yes	2-3 sentence summary for cards
Body	Yes	Full article using the Markdown editor
Tags	No	Categories for organization
Featured Image	No	URL for header image
Published	Yes	Toggle — only published posts appear on the site

3. Click **Save Post**

4.2 Writing Best Practices

- **Keep paragraphs short** — 2-3 sentences for easy scanning
- **Use headings** (`## Heading`) to break up long articles
- **Target 300-800 words** per post
- **Include a call to action** — link to an upcoming event or community channel
- **Add images** to increase engagement
- **Use internal links** when referencing events or other pages

4.3 Using the Markdown Editor

The editor includes a toolbar with these buttons:

Button	What It Does	Markdown Inserted
B	Bold text	<code>**text**</code>
<i>/</i>	Italic text	<code>*text*</code>
H2	Heading 2	<code>## Heading</code>
H3	Heading 3	<code>### Heading</code>
List	Bullet list	<code>- item</code>
Link	Insert link	<code>[text](url)</code>
Image	Insert image	<code>![alt](url)</code>

You can also type Markdown directly in the text area.

4.4 Content Calendar

Suggested publishing schedule:

Day	Content Type	Example
Monday	Weekly preview	"This Week at Bangkok Shambhala"
Wednesday	Post-session update	Recap + reflection
Friday	Weekend preview	Upcoming workshop details
1st of month	Monthly newsletter	Events digest + community news

5. Managing Images

5.1 Image Guidelines

Aspect	Recommendation
Format	WebP or JPEG (photos), PNG (graphics)
Max width	1200px
Max file size	200KB
Naming	Descriptive: <code>wednesday-meditation-group.jpg</code>
Alt text	Always describe the image content

5.2 Adding Images to Content

1. Upload your image to a hosting service (e.g., Cloudinary, Imgur, or your preferred CDN)
2. Copy the image URL
3. In the admin editor, click the **Image** toolbar button or type `![description](url)` directly
4. Paste the image URL
5. Always add a descriptive alt text for accessibility

Tip: Compress images before uploading using squoosh.app or tinypng.com.

6. Newsletter Management

6.1 How Signups Work

1. Visitors enter their email in the newsletter form (footer or dedicated section)
2. The form includes a hidden **honeypot field** to block bots
3. A **rate limiter** prevents abuse (max 5 signups/minute per IP)
4. Valid emails are forwarded to **Brevo** (your email service)

6.2 Managing Subscribers in Brevo

1. Log in to app.brevo.com
2. Go to **Contacts** to see all subscribers
3. Create **segments** for targeted campaigns
4. Send newsletters using Brevo's email editor

6.3 Unsubscribe Handling

Brevo automatically adds an unsubscribe link to every email. This is required by law (PDPA in Thailand, GDPR in Europe).

7. Automation (n8n)

7.1 Available Workflows

The site includes 4 pre-built n8n automation workflows:

Workflow	Trigger	What It Does
Event Published	Webhook	Sends newsletter + prepares social copy
Weekly Reminder	Monday 9:00 AM	Sends weekly event digest to WhatsApp + email
Broken Link Monitor	Sunday 3:00 AM	Checks all URLs, emails alert if any are broken
Social Copy Generator	Webhook	Uses AI to generate Facebook/Instagram/WhatsApp/LINE copy

7.2 Setting Up n8n

1. Install n8n (self-hosted or n8n.cloud)
2. Import workflow JSON files from `/automation/n8n/`
3. Configure credentials (Brevo API key, OpenAI key, etc.)
4. Activate the workflows

7.3 Monitoring

- Check n8n's **Execution History** weekly for failed runs
- Review the broken link report if you receive an alert email
- Test the event published webhook after deploying changes

8. SEO Management

8.1 What's Automatic

The site handles these SEO aspects automatically:

- **Schema.org** structured data on every page
- **Open Graph** tags for social sharing
- **Sitemap** at `/sitemap.xml` (auto-generated)
- **Robots.txt** at `/robots.txt`
- **Canonical URLs**

- **Breadcrumb** structured data

8.2 What You Control

When creating content, optimize these fields:

Field	SEO Impact	Tips
Title	High	Include keywords: "Meditation Workshop Bangkok"
Summary/Excerpt	High	This appears in Google search results
Body headings	Medium	Use <code>##</code> and <code>###</code> for structure
Alt text	Medium	Describe images for search engines
Tags	Low	Helps internal categorization

8.3 Google Search Console

1. Visit search.google.com/search-console
2. Add property for `shambhala-bangkok.org`
3. Submit sitemap: `https://shambhala-bangkok.org/sitemap.xml`
4. Monitor for crawl errors weekly

9. Site Monitoring

9.1 Regular Checks

Weekly:

- ☐ Check site loads correctly
- ☐ Review Plausible analytics at plausible.io
- ☐ Update event statuses (mark past events)

Monthly:

- ☐ Check Google Search Console for errors
- ☐ Review newsletter subscriber count in Brevo

- ☐ Run Lighthouse audit (Chrome DevTools → Lighthouse tab)

Quarterly:

- ☐ Review and rotate API keys
- ☐ Update dependencies (coordinate with developer)
- ☐ Full QA pass (see QA Checklist in repository)

9.2 Vercel Dashboard

Your hosting dashboard at vercel.com shows:

- **Deployments** — build history and status
- **Analytics** — Web Vitals performance data
- **Logs** — API route execution logs
- **Domains** — custom domain configuration

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Changes don't appear after saving	Wait 1-2 min for rebuild. Check Vercel dashboard for build errors.
Admin login fails	Clear browser cache. Try incognito mode. Verify ADMIN_EMAIL and ADMIN_PASSWORD env vars.
Images don't load	Verify the image URL is correct and publicly accessible.
Event not on homepage	Verify status is <code>upcoming</code> and date is in the future.
Newsletter signup fails	Check Brevo API key in Vercel env vars. Check API logs.
404 errors for old URLs	Add a redirect in <code>next.config.js</code> (developer task).
Site down	Check status.vercel.com . Rollback in Vercel if recent deploy broke it.
Slow page load	Run Lighthouse audit. Check for large images. Contact developer.

11. Security Reminders

- **Never share** admin credentials (email/password) publicly
 - **Never commit** API keys or secrets to the repository
 - **Review** who has admin credentials quarterly — change password if a member departs
 - **Rotate** API keys (GitHub token, Brevo, n8n) every 3-6 months
 - **Report** any suspicious activity to the site administrator immediately
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12. Getting Help

Type of Help	Contact
Content questions	Community coordinator
Technical issues	Site developer
Admin panel access	Site administrator
Brevo / newsletters	Site administrator
n8n automations	Site developer

Bangkok Shambhala Admin Guide v1.0 — March 2026 For the latest version, check the repository at [/docs/guides/](#)